



Discussion Guide: Shawn Duncan

Changing Mission for Good

Reflect

- Shawn begins by telling a parable about a woman committed to filling empty buckets with water (the Cold Water Collective). What did you learn from this story and how did it impact your view of mission or service projects?
- Consider the common proverb: If you give a person a fish, they'll eat for a day. If you teach a person to fish, they'll eat for a lifetime. What does this proverb assume about the nature of material poverty and its solutions? How has this talk given you a different perspective?
- Shawn suggests that Jesus' parable of the Good Samaritan is intended to counter "othering" in all of its forms. (You may want to take a look at that text together: Luke 10:25–37.) Who is the "other" in this story? Who is it hard for you or your faith community to consider a neighbor? Why?

Respond

- Shawn names the idea of "authentic encounter" as the key to transforming mission for good. How would you define the idea of authentic encounter? What does it entail and/or what does it look like?
- Describe a situation in which you have had an authentic encounter with a stranger or someone you served. In your own life, what stands in the way of moving toward authentic encounters more regularly?
- Consider a mission or service project sponsored by your faith community. How would cultivating relational proximity and shared leadership positively impact all those involved?